

Bazaar

The latest and greatest products reviewed to help you decide what you want to buy

**Storyteller for kids**

TROBO is a storytelling toy robot which, alongside an iPad app, teaches kids about science and maths <http://digit.in/TROBO>



2-in-1 Hybrid Hype

The post-PC era is full of 2-in-1, hybrid devices. Devices that are half-tablet, half-laptop abound in the marketplace, confusing customers with choices. Should you buy one? We test the suspects.

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We remember the moment clearly. At COMPUTEX 2013, in the month of June, Taiwan, Intel showed off a variety of 2-in-1 devices at its booth. They were that many in number, these 2-in-1 hybrid devices, that it clearly outnumbered any other attraction at Intel's booth. That was a watershed moment in the independent evolution of tablets and laptops and the story of their inevitable convergence.

Over a year later, we are happy to say that hybrid devices are now becoming mainstream items in manufacturers' portfolio of computing devices offered to customers. They aren't that widespread yet, but you'll be hard pressed to find an electronic store that doesn't house at least one exhibit.

Hybrid devices are nothing but laptops with tablet features or a tablet attached to a laptop base. Whichever way you look at hybrids, they're here to make our life easier (so they say, eh) and give us enough reason into investing in a device which is more than it meets the eye.

In the following pages, we've pitted six hybrid laptops against each other, which represent the best offerings at their respective price brackets. From a detachable screen laptop that sells under 35k mark to 360° rotating-hinge industrial design marvels that transform from a laptop to a tablet within seconds, we have something to whet everyone's hybrid device appetite.

Who should buy a 2-in-1 device, you ask? Anyone who needs a laptop first or is interested in buying a tablet with an attached keyboard. Because that sort of open mindedness is necessary to not be disappointed in

your purchase. While all hybrid devices are technically laptops, not all of them are tablets in the strictest sense of the word. In the attempt to combine the best of both worlds, there are a few points to remember about these 2-in-1 devices. First off, Hybrid devices that are below the 50k mark, don't offer good performance for a laptop. They're also slightly bulky, so are hybrids with 15-inch screens, and uncomfortable to use as traditional tablets meant for single handed use — unless these hybrids have detachable screens. Overall, there's plenty to be excited about with the